INVOICE

Install Guide

Setting up Invoice on your computer and connecting it to Gmail

Invoice finds the invoices you receive by email in your Gmail account, saves their attachments into a folder of your choice and keeps a list of them so you can follow what is paid and what is not. This guide takes you from nothing to a first import. Allow about 20 minutes; you only do it once.

Version 0.1.0 · 08 November 2026

Contents

1. Before you start 3
2. Install Python 3
3. Download and install Invoice 4
4. Connect to Google: credentials.json 5
5. Write your configuration 6
6. Sign in to Gmail 6
7. Check and run a first import 7
8. Troubleshooting 8

1. Before you start

You will need:

- A computer running **Windows 10/11**, **macOS** or **Linux**, with a web browser. The program runs on your own computer; your invoices never leave it.
- Your **Gmail account** (the address and password — the password is typed only on Google's own sign-in page, never into Invoice).
- **Python 3.11 or newer** (step 2 explains how to install it).
- A **Google Cloud project**, free of charge (step 4). Google requires it for any program that reads Gmail. No credit card is needed.

The installation has seven steps:

Step	What you do	Time
2	Install Python	5 min
3	Download Invoice and install it	3 min
4	Create the Google Cloud project and get *credentials.json*	10 min
5	Write your configuration file	2 min
6	Sign in to Gmail	1 min
7	Check everything and run a first import	2 min

> **Tip.** In this guide, lines in grey boxes are commands to type in a **terminal**: *Terminal* on macOS and Linux, *PowerShell* on Windows (Start menu, type “PowerShell”). Press Enter after each line.

2. Install Python

First check whether Python is already installed:

```
python3 --version        # macOS / Linux
py --version             # Windows
```

If it prints `Python 3.11` or a higher number, go to step 3. Otherwise:

- **Windows**: download the installer from *python.org/downloads*. On the first screen, tick **“Add python.exe to PATH”**, then click *Install Now*.
- **macOS**: download the installer from *python.org/downloads* and run it; or, with Homebrew, run `brew install python`.
- **Linux** (Debian/Ubuntu): `sudo apt install python3 python3-venv`.

Close and reopen the terminal, then run the version check again.

3. Download and install Invoice

3.1 Get the files

Either download the project as a ZIP from GitHub (*Code › Download ZIP*) and unzip it into a folder such as *Documents/Invoice*, or, if you use git:

```
git clone https://github.com/gaillotte/invoice.git Invoice
```

Then go into that folder in the terminal:

```
cd Documents/Invoice     # adjust to where you put it
```

3.2 Install

This creates a private Python environment for Invoice (a *.venv* folder) so it does not interfere with anything else on your computer:

macOS / Linux

```
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -e .
```

Windows (PowerShell)

```
py -m venv .venv
.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
pip install -e .
```

When it finishes, check that the `invoices` command works:

```
invoices --help
```

> **Important.** Each time you open a new terminal to use Invoice, first go to the Invoice folder and run the **activate** line again (`source .venv/bin/activate` or `.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1`). Otherwise you will get "command not found".

> **Tip.** If Windows refuses to run Activate.ps1 ("running scripts is disabled"), run `Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned` once, then try again.

4. Connect to Google: credentials.json

Google does not let programs sign in to Gmail with your password. Instead, you register Invoice as your own small private app in Google Cloud; Google then gives you a file, *credentials.json*, that identifies the app. You sign in with your account in step 6.

Google reorganises its console from time to time, so menu names may differ slightly from those below; the steps stay the same.

4.1 Create a project

1. Open **console.cloud.google.com** and sign in with your Gmail account. Accept the terms if asked.
2. Click the project selector at the top of the page, then **New project**. Name it “Invoice” and click **Create**. Make sure the new project is selected.

4.2 Enable the Gmail API

1. Menu › **APIs & Services** › **Library**.
2. Search for **Gmail API**, open it and click **Enable**.

4.3 Describe the app (consent screen)

1. Menu › **Google Auth Platform** (called *OAuth consent screen* in some versions) › **Get started**.
2. App name: *Invoice*. User support email: your address. Click Next.
3. Audience: **External**. Click Next.
4. Contact information: your address. Accept the policy and click **Create**.
5. Open **Audience** › **Test users** › **Add users**, add **your Gmail address** and save. Only addresses listed here can use the app.

> **Important.** Leave the app in **Testing** mode. Do not click “Publish app”: publishing would require a security review by Google and is not needed for personal use.

4.4 Create the credentials

1. Open **Clients** (or *APIs & Services › Credentials › Create credentials › OAuth client ID*).
2. Application type: **Desktop app**. Name: *Invoice*. Click **Create**.
3. Click **Download JSON**.
4. Move the downloaded file into the Invoice folder and rename it exactly **credentials.json**.

> **Tip.** credentials.json identifies the app, not you: on its own it gives no access to your mail. Still, keep it to yourself.

5. Write your configuration

Copy the example configuration file:

```
cp config.example.toml config.toml      # macOS / Linux
copy config.example.toml config.toml    # Windows
```

Open `config.toml` in a text editor (Notepad, TextEdit in plain-text mode, VS Code…) and set at least these three lines:

```
account = "your.name@gmail.com"
keywords = ["Facture", "Facturation", "Invoice"]
invoices_dir = "~/Documents/Factures"
```

- `account`: the Gmail address to manage.
- `keywords`: the words that identify an invoice email (see the User Manual).
- `invoices_dir`: where the invoice files will be saved. `~` means your home folder. On Windows you can also write `C:/Users/you/Documents/Factures` (use forward slashes).

Every other setting has a sensible default; the User Manual describes them all.

> **Important.** Do not add your Gmail password to this file. Invoice refuses to start if it finds a *password* line, because Google would reject it anyway.

6. Sign in to Gmail

```
invoices auth
```

1. Your browser opens Google's sign-in page, with your account pre-selected.
2. Google shows **“Google hasn't verified this app”**. This is expected: it is your own app from step 4. Click **Continue**.
3. Google lists what Invoice asks for: read your email and manage labels. Click **Continue**.
4. The browser says the authentication flow has completed; you can close the tab.

The terminal then prints:

```
Authorised as your.name@gmail.com. Token saved to token.json
```

The file `token.json` lets Invoice reconnect without asking you again. While your Google project is in Testing mode, Google makes this sign-in expire after **7 days**; Invoice then simply opens the sign-in page again.

What Invoice can and cannot do with your mailbox

- It **can** read your emails and add a label (*invoices-processed*) to the ones it has handled.
- It **cannot** send emails, and cannot permanently delete anything.
- You can cut its access at any time on **myaccount.google.com/permissions**.

7. Check and run a first import

Show the search Invoice will use in Gmail:

```
invoices query
```

```
Account: your.name@gmail.com
Invoices folder: /home/you/Documents/Factures
Keywords: Facture, Facturation, Invoice
Gmail query: has:attachment {subject:Facture subject:Facturation subject:Invoice
    filename:Facture filename:Facturation filename:Invoice} -label:invoices-processed
    newer_than:1y
```

> **Tip.** Paste the “Gmail query” line into the Gmail search box: you see exactly the emails Invoice will look at.

Preview the import without saving anything:

```
invoices fetch --dry-run
```

If the list looks right, import for real, then display the result:

```
invoices fetch
invoices list
```

Installation is complete. Continue with the **User Manual** for everyday use.

8. Troubleshooting

Message or symptom	What to do
`invoices: command not found` / "not recognized"	Go to the Invoice folder and activate the environment (step 3.2).
`credentials.json not found`	Put the file downloaded in step 4.4 in the Invoice folder, named exactly credentials.json (Windows may hide a second ".json": enable *File name extensions* in Explorer's View menu).
Google: "Access blocked: Invoice has not completed the Google verification process" / error 403 access_denied	Your address is not a test user. Add it in step 4.3, point 5.
Google: "Gmail API has not been used in project … or it is disabled"	Enable the Gmail API (step 4.2), wait a minute, try again.
`Signed in as … but the config file says account = …`	You signed in with another account. Delete `token.json` and run `invoices auth` again, choosing the right account.
`'password' is not supported`	Remove the password line from `config.toml`.
`Unknown config key`	A setting name is misspelt in config.toml; compare with config.example.toml.
The sign-in page opens every week	Normal while the Google project is in Testing mode (see step 6).
The browser does not open during sign-in	Copy the long URL printed in the terminal into your browser.
`fetch` finds no email	Run `invoices query` and paste the query into Gmail. Check the keywords and the time limit (newer_than), and that the emails have attachments.

Uninstall

1. Revoke access on **myaccount.google.com/permissions** (entry "Invoice").
2. Optionally delete the Google Cloud project (console › IAM & Admin › Settings › Shut down).
3. Delete the Invoice folder. Your invoice files in *invoices_dir* are kept unless you delete them too.